

Young Goodman Brown

Nathaniel Hawthorne · 1835

First published: New-England Magazine, Apr 1835

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/Mosses_from_an_Old_Manse/Young_Goodman_Brown (revision 8986229), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 10–12 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). The scaffolded-support track works from the full text with scaffolds. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Young Goodman Brown suggest about faith and doubt?
- What does Young Goodman Brown suggest about hypocrisy?
- What does Young Goodman Brown suggest about the nature of evil?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the story in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the story quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Young Goodman Brown	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*faith and doubt* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Young Goodman Brown

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Nathaniel Hawthorne's life or times connects to faith and doubt in “Young Goodman Brown”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (faith and doubt, hypocrisy, the nature of evil).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

Author biography

Nathaniel Hawthorne was born in Salem, Massachusetts, on 4 July 1804; his ancestor John Hathorne was a judge in the Salem witch trials of 1692, a family history Hawthorne felt as a burden. He later changed the spelling of his surname to Hawthorne; why is uncertain, though many link it to his discomfort with his ancestors. After graduating from Bowdoin College in 1825 he spent years writing in near-seclusion in Salem, publishing Twice-Told Tales in 1837. He lived briefly at the utopian Brook Farm community, worked at the Salem Custom House, and achieved fame with The Scarlet Letter (1850) and The House of the Seven Gables (1851). He served as U.S. consul in Liverpool and died on 19 May 1864 in Plymouth, New Hampshire.

Historical and cultural context

The story is set in Salem village in Puritan New England, around the end of the seventeenth century, the world of the 1692 witch trials. Hawthorne's great-great-grandfather John Hathorne was a judge at those trials, and Hawthorne added the "w" to his name partly to distance himself from that inheritance. Puritans believed in human depravity and watched one another for signs of sin.

Publication and reception, then and now

First published anonymously in the New-England Magazine in April 1835; collected in Mosses from an Old Manse (1846).

Then: Little noticed at first; Herman Melville praised the story warmly in his 1850 essay "Hawthorne and His Mosses."

Now: A central text of American Romanticism and "dark romanticism," studied for its allegory and its deliberate ambiguity.

Overview (spoiler-free)

A young Puritan husband leaves his new wife, Faith, for one night to keep a mysterious appointment in the forest with a traveller who carries a serpent-like staff.

Main themes

- loss of faith and innocence: Faith is both his wife and his belief.
- hypocrisy: the "pious" townspeople in the forest.
- ambiguity and suspicion: not knowing the truth destroys him.

Why it matters

The story asks what happens when we see evil in everyone, and how suspicion poisons a community, from 1692 Salem to modern rumour.

Spoilers · teacher only

In the forest he sees the town's most respected people, and apparently Faith, gathering for a witches' meeting; he calls on her to resist and wakes alone. Whether it was a dream or not, he lives the rest of his life gloomy and distrustful, and dies without hope.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Before we open Young Goodman Brown: Can learning one bad thing about someone change how you see everyone?
Prompt: Before we open Young Goodman Brown: Can learning one bad thing about someone change how you see everyone?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
allegory; ambiguity; Puritanism; symbol; dark romanticism.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).
About the author. Nathaniel Hawthorne was born in Salem, Massachusetts, on 4 July 1804; his ancestor John Hathorne was a judge in the Salem witch trials of 1692, a family history Hawthorne felt as a burden. He later changed the spelling of his surname to Hawthorne; why is uncertain, though many link it to his discomfort with his ancestors. After graduating from Bowdoin College in 1825 he spent years writing in near-seclusion in Salem, publishing Twice-Told Tales in 1837. He lived briefly at the utopian Brook Farm community, worked at the Salem Custom House, and achieved fame with The Scarlet Letter (1850) and The House of the Seven Gables (1851). He served as U.S. consul in Liverpool and died on 19 May 1864 in Plymouth, New Hampshire. The world of the book. The story is set in Salem village in Puritan New England, around the end of the seventeenth century, the world of the 1692 witch trials. Hawthorne's great-great-grandfather John Hathorne was a judge at those trials, and Hawthorne added the "w" to his name partly to distance himself from that inheritance. Puritans believed in human depravity and watched one another for signs of sin. Publication and reception. First published anonymously in the New-England Magazine in April 1835; collected in Mosses from an Old Manse (1846). Then: Little noticed at first; Herman Melville praised the story warmly in his 1850 essay "Hawthorne and His Mosses." Now: A central text of American Romanticism and "dark romanticism," studied for its allegory and its deliberate ambiguity.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Young Goodman Brown came forth at sunset into the street at Salem village; but put his head back, after crossing the threshold, to..." slowly and put it in my own words: Young Goodman Brown leaves his house at sunset but turns back to kiss his young wife. Next, craft. I notice he hesitates on the threshold, a sign of doubt. The strongest word is "sunset": it is the start of night and darkness, matching the journey into evil. Then, effect. What does this first sentence suggest about Brown's journey? My answer: He is leaving goodness behind for something dark; the hesitation hints he knows the journey is wrong.

> *Young Goodman Brown came forth at sunset into the street at Salem village; but put his head back, after crossing the threshold, to exchange a parting kiss with his young wife.* *(Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Young Goodman Brown came forth at sunset into the street at Salem village; but put his head back, after crossing the threshold, to…" slowly and put it in my own words: Young Goodman Brown leaves his house at sunset but turns back to kiss his young wife. Next, craft. I notice he hesitates on the threshold, a sign of doubt. The strongest word is "sunset": it is the start of night and darkness, matching the journey into evil. Then, effect. What does this first sentence suggest about Brown's journey? My answer: He is leaving goodness behind for something dark; the hesitation hints he knows the journey is wrong.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): A young Puritan husband leaves his new wife, Faith, for one night to keep a mysterious appointment in the forest with a traveller who carries a serpent-like staff. Themes to track: loss of faith and innocence: Faith is both his wife and his belief. hypocrisy: the "pious" townspeople in the forest. ambiguity and suspicion: not knowing the truth destroys him.

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Page: faith and doubt. Prediction: Goodman Brown's night journey into the Salem forest, leaving his wife Faith at home, will test what he believes about his neighbors. Question: is what he sees real, a dream, or a trick?
Task: Set up a reading journal for Young Goodman Brown: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Page: faith and doubt. Prediction: Goodman Brown's night journey into the Salem forest, leaving his wife Faith at home, will test what he believes about his neighbors. Question: is what he sees real, a dream, or a trick?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does Young Goodman Brown still matter? The story asks what happens when we see evil in everyone, and how suspicion poisons a community, from 1692 Salem to modern rumour.
Anchor question: Why might Young Goodman Brown still be taught today?
Facilitation: The story asks what happens when we see evil in everyone, and how suspicion poisons a community, from 1692 Salem to modern rumour.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Hawthorne's ancestor John Hathorne was a judge at the Salem witch trials. How might that history shape a story set in Salem village? Answer: Accept answers such as: he was haunted by his family's guilt; the story shows how suspicion spreads; he questions Puritan certainty about good and evil.
Exit ticket: Hawthorne's ancestor John Hathorne was a judge at the Salem witch trials. How might that history shape a story set in Salem village?
Answer: Accept answers such as: he was haunted by his family's guilt; the story shows how suspicion spreads; he questions Puritan certainty about good and evil.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: Young Goodman Brown.

Teacher notes · sources: Britannica, "Nathaniel Hawthorne" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Nathaniel-Hawthorne); The House of the Seven Gables, "Nathaniel Hawthorne" (https://7gables.org/nathaniel-hawthorne/); Hawthorne in Salem, "Young Goodman Brown" (https://www.hawthorneinsalem.org/); Library of America, Hawthorne: Tales and Sketches (https://www.loa.org/books/104-tales-and-sketches)

Lesson 2: Young Goodman Brown

Focus: the loss of faith in human goodness

Objective: Students will analyze how allusion develops in "Young Goodman Brown" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (witchcraft, devil figure, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Sensitive content: Witchcraft; devil figure. Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…in New England. The deacons of many a church have drunk the communion wine with me; the selectm…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: Heads-up: this story includes witchcraft; devil figure.
Suggested language: "Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

In Puritan Salem, Goodman Brown leaves his new wife Faith for a night errand in the forest, where he walks with a traveler resembling his own grandfather, carrying a serpent-like staff. He sees pious townspeople, his minister and finally Faith herself gathering for a witches' communion. He cries out for Faith to resist and finds himself alone. Whether dream or not, he lives out his life gloomy and distrustful, and 'his dying hour was gloom.'

Background: Hawthorne (1835) was descended from John Hathorne, a judge at the 1692 Salem witch trials.

Significance: An allegory central to American literature courses; in Gale's Short Stories for Students vol. 1.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What would happen to you if you came to believe everyone you trust is secretly bad? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to loss of faith and innocence because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this story includes witchcraft; devil figure.
Prompt: What would happen to you if you came to believe everyone you trust is secretly bad?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to loss of faith and innocence because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: nettled — irritated; annoyed; intercepted — blocked; cut off (the light); auditor — someone who listens attentively; composedly — in a self-collected or self-possessed manner; meditate — reflect deeply on a subject. "intercepted": Origin of "intercept": Latin interceptum. "auditor": Origin: Anglo-Norman auditour; earlier Latin audītor ("hearer").
Words: nettled: irritated; annoyed · intercepted: blocked; cut off (the light) · auditor: someone who listens attentively · composedly: in a self-collected or self-possessed manner · meditate: reflect deeply on a subject

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Hawthorne (1835) was descended from John Hathorne, a judge at the 1692 Salem witch trials. An allegory central to American literature courses; in Gale's Short Stories for Students vol. 1. Allegory: Names are meanings: Goodman Brown (an everyman) and Faith; the journey into the forest is a journey into doubt. Symbolism: The pink ribbons tie Faith to innocence; when one floats down from the sky, Brown despairs. Ambiguity: Hawthorne repeatedly hedges ("Had Goodman Brown fallen asleep in the forest and only dreamed a wild dream of a witch-meeting?"). Watch for the forest: the wilderness of doubt and sin that the Puritans feared.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "My Faith is gone" slowly and put it in my own words: When Brown sees his wife's pink ribbon in the forest, he cries that his Faith is gone. Next, craft. I notice "Faith" is both his wife's name and his religious belief. The strongest word is "Faith": the double meaning means he has lost both his wife's innocence and his trust in goodness. Then, effect. What does Brown mean when he cries "My Faith is gone"? My answer: When Brown cries "My Faith is gone," he means both his wife Faith and his belief that anyone is good; the line marks the moment his view of the world turns dark.

> *My Faith is gone (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 124)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "My Faith is gone" slowly and put it in my own words: When Brown sees his wife's pink ribbon in the forest, he cries that his Faith is gone. Next, craft. I notice "Faith" is both his wife's name and his religious belief. The strongest word is "Faith": the double meaning means he has lost both his wife's innocence and his trust in goodness. Then, effect. What does Brown mean when he cries "My Faith is gone"? My answer: When Brown cries "My Faith is gone," he means both his wife Faith and his belief that anyone is good; the line marks the moment his view of the world turns dark.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The adjectives pile up and darken; "if not a desperate" hints at spiritual despair, the worst sin for a Puritan. Ask: How does this line connect to loss of faith and innocence? Expected: Once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. (His fate.)

> *A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The adjectives pile up and darken; "if not a desperate" hints at spiritual despair, the worst sin for a Puritan.
Ask: How does this line connect to loss of faith and innocence?
Expected answer: Once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. (His fate.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the story for allegory, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about the loss of faith in human goodness? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Young Goodman Brown develops the idea of the loss of faith in human goodness. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. When the text says “A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164), it shows this directly. Whether the meeting was real or a dream, he becomes "a stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man," turning from Faith herself; the vision teaches him that "Evil is the nature of mankind," and he can never unlearn it.
Task: Annotate the story for allegory, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about the loss of faith in human goodness? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Young Goodman Brown develops the idea of the loss of faith in human goodness. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. When the text says “A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164), it shows this directly. Whether the meeting was real or a dream, he becomes "a stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man," turning from Faith herself; the vision teaches him that "Evil is the nature of mankind," and he can never unlearn it.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What would happen to you if you came to believe everyone you trust is secretly bad? Ask: does Brown fail because he sees evil, or because he refuses to see anything else?
Anchor question: What would happen to you if you came to believe everyone you trust is secretly bad?
Facilitation: Ask: does Brown fail because he sees evil, or because he refuses to see anything else?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about the loss of faith in human goodness? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. ("A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become", Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about the loss of faith in human goodness? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. ("A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become", Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how allegory shapes the loss of faith in human goodness. Key takeaway: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Allegory:** Names are meanings: Goodman Brown (an everyman) and Faith; the journey into the forest is a journey into doubt.
- **Symbolism:** The pink ribbons tie Faith to innocence; when one floats down from the sky, Brown despairs.
- **Ambiguity:** Hawthorne repeatedly hedges ("Had Goodman Brown fallen asleep in the forest and only dreamed a wild dream of a witch-meeting?").

Themes and how they develop

- **loss of faith and innocence:** once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone.

Symbols and motifs

- **the forest:** the wilderness of doubt and sin that the Puritans feared.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "My Faith is gone" (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 124) The pun.
- "Evil is the nature of mankind" (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 149) The devil's sermon.
- "A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become" (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164) His fate.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward.
Evidence: "A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become" (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164)
Reasoning: Whether the meeting was real or a dream, he becomes "a stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man," turning from Faith herself; the vision teaches him that "Evil is the nature of mankind," and he can never unlearn it.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
nettled (adjective)	irritated; annoyed	*considerably nettled, "there is my wife, Faith.*	
intercepted (verb)	blocked; cut off (the light)	*Though their figures brushed the small boughs by the wayside, it could not be seen that they intercepted, even for a moment, the faint gleam from the strip of bright sky athwart which they must have passed.*	"intercepted": Origin of "intercept": Latin interceptum. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/intercept#Etymology)
auditor (noun)	someone who listens attentively	*They continued to walk onward, while the elder traveller exhorted his companion to make good speed and persevere in the path, discoursing so aptly that his arguments seemed rather to spring up in the bosom of his auditor than to be suggested by himself.*	"auditor": Origin: Anglo-Norman auditour; earlier Latin audītor ("hearer"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/auditor#Etymology)
composedly (adverb)	in a self-collected or self-possessed manner	*composedly. "Sit here and rest yourself a while; and when you*	
meditate (verb)	reflect deeply on a subject	*The good old minister was taking a walk along the graveyard to get an appetite for breakfast and meditate his sermon, and bestowed a blessing, as he passed, on Goodman Brown.*	
persevere (verb)	be persistent, refuse to stop	*They continued to walk onward, while the elder traveller exhorted his companion to*	

		make good speed and persevere in the path, discoursing so aptly that his arguments seemed rather to spring up in the bosom of his auditor than to be suggested by himself.	
doubting (verb)	feeling unsure	*He looked up to the sky, doubting whether there really was a heaven above him.*	
conversing (verb)	carry on a conversation	*On came the hoof tramps and the voices of the riders, two grave old voices, conversing soberly as they drew near.*	
considerably (adverb)	to a great extent or degree	*considerably nettled, "there is my wife, Faith.*	

Discussion questions

1. What would happen to you if you came to believe everyone you trust is secretly bad?
2. Where does allusion appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with faith and doubt?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What is the name of Brown's wife? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Faith
2. What does the traveler carry? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A staff that looks like a twisting serpent
3. Whom does Brown see in the forest? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Pious townspeople and his minister
4. What does Brown find on a branch? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A pink ribbon from Faith's cap
5. How does Brown live after that night? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Stern, sad and distrustful until death
6. Retell the three most important events of “Young Goodman Brown” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In Puritan Salem, Goodman Brown leaves his new wife Faith for a night errand in the forest, where he walks with a traveler resembling his own grandfather, carrying a serpent-like staff. He sees pious townspeople, his minister and finally Faith herself gathering for a witches' communion. He cries out for Faith to resist and finds himself alone. Whether dream or not, he lives out his life gloomy…

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Young Goodman Brown”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Young Goodman Brown” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: “considerably nettled, "there is my wife, Faith.” What does “nettled” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: nettled: irritated; annoyed.
10. Reread: “Though their figures brushed the small boughs by the wayside, it could not be seen that they intercepted, even for a moment, the faint gleam from the strip of bright sky athwart which they must have passed.” What does “intercepted” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: intercepted: blocked; cut off (the light).

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Young Goodman Brown” suggest about the loss of faith in human goodness? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An allegory central to American literature courses; in Gale's Short Stories for Students vol. 1.
2. Find one example of allusion in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.9, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion.
3. How does the symbolism in this story shape what we understand about the loss of faith in human goodness? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. Useful evidence: “My Faith is gone” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 124): The pun. On symbolism: The pink ribbons tie Faith to innocence; when one floats down from the sky, Brown despairs. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “They continued to walk onward, while the elder traveller exhorted his companion to make good speed and persevere in the path, discoursing so aptly that his arguments seemed rather…”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Young Goodman Brown”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: In Puritan Salem, Goodman Brown leaves his new wife Faith for a night errand in the forest, where he walks with a traveler resembling his own grandfather, carrying a serpent-like staff. He sees pious townspeople, his minister and finally Faith herself gathering for a witches' communion. He cries…
6. As the opening story, what does “Young Goodman Brown” set up that the rest of Young Goodman Brown will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. Useful evidence: “Evil is the nature of mankind” (Young Goodman Brown,

paragraph 149): The devil's sermon. Theme link: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. Useful evidence: “A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164): His fate. Theme link: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “What would happen to you if you came to believe everyone you trust is secretly bad?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with faith and doubt? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. Useful evidence: “My Faith is gone” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 124): The pun. Theme link: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Hawthorne (1835) was descended from John Hathorne, a judge at the 1692 Salem witch trials. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. Useful evidence: “Evil is the nature of mankind” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 149): The devil's sermon. Theme link: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “An allegory central to American literature courses; in Gale's Short Stories for Students vol. 1.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. Useful evidence: “A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164): His fate. Theme link: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and

evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. Useful evidence: “My Faith is gone” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 124): The pun. Theme link: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Young Goodman Brown” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the loss of faith in human goodness? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. Useful evidence: “Evil is the nature of mankind” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 149): The devil's sermon. Theme link: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Young Goodman Brown”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. Useful evidence: “A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164): His fate. Theme link: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this story to hypocrisy: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. Useful evidence: “My Faith is gone” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 124): The pun. Theme link: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the allusion in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.9, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. Useful evidence: “Evil is the nature of mankind” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 149): The devil's sermon. Theme link: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Young Goodman Brown” treats the loss of faith in human goodness with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Young Goodman Brown see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. Useful evidence: “A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164): His fate. Theme link: once

Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. As the final story, does this ending resolve faith and doubt? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. Useful evidence: “My Faith is gone” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 124): The pun. Theme link: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the loss of faith in human goodness? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. Useful evidence: “Evil is the nature of mankind” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 149): The devil's sermon. Theme link: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Nathaniel Hawthorne about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. Useful evidence: “A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164): His fate. Theme link: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the name of Brown's wife?

   A. Faith

   B. Hope

   C. Prudence

   D. Charity

   Key: A (Faith)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the traveler carry?

   A. A staff that looks like a twisting serpent

   B. A sword

   C. A lantern

D. A Bible

Key: A (A staff that looks like a twisting serpent)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 77: “I shall take a cut _____ the woods until we have left this” Word bank: turned, through, threshold, tremble

   Key: through

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 44? “I have been as well _____ with your family as with ever a one among the Puritans; and that's no trifle to say.”

   A. ribbons

   B. acquainted

   C. journey

   D. tremble

   Key: B (acquainted)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 4? “Then God bless you!’ said Faith, with the pink _____; ‘and may you find all well when you come back.”

   A. excellent

   B. acquainted

   C. sometimes

   D. ribbons

   Key: D (ribbons)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 16: “His head being _____ back, he passed a crook of the road, and,” Word bank: disappeared, excellent, turned, formerly

   Key: turned

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 97? “So saying, he threw it down at her feet, where, perhaps, it assumed life, being one of the rods which its owner had _____ lent to the Egyptian magi.”

   A. formerly

   B. indistinct

   C. people

   D. trouble

   Key: A (formerly)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Brown find on a branch?

   A. A pink ribbon from Faith's cap

   B. A letter

   C. A feather

   D. A cross

   Key: A (A pink ribbon from Faith's cap)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He looked up to the sky, _____ whether there really was a heaven above him.” Word bank: intercepted, doubting, nettled, auditor

   Key: doubting

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "They continued to walk onward, while the elder traveller exhorted his companion to make good speed and _____ in the path, discoursing so aptly that his arguments seemed rather to spring up in the bosom of his auditor than to be suggested by himself." Word bank: intercepted, persevere, auditor, nettled
    Key: persevere
11. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The good old minister was taking a walk along the graveyard to get an appetite for breakfast and _____ his sermon, and bestowed a blessing, as he passed, on Goodman Brown." Word bank: auditor, intercepted, meditate, nettled
    Key: meditate
12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 1 reveal about the character or situation? "And Faith, as the wife was aptly named, thrust her own pretty head into the street, letting the wind play with the pink ribbons of her cap while she called to Goodman Brown." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 1) shows the situation turning on faith and doubt: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The words "letting" and "ribbons" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.
13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 97 reveal about the character or situation? "He had cast up his eyes in astonishment, and, looking down again, beheld neither Goody Cloyse nor the serpentine staff, but his fellow-traveller alone, who waited for him as calmly as if nothing had happened." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 97) shows the situation turning on faith and doubt: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The words "astonishment" and "serpentine" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 7 shapes its tone: "So they parted; and the young man pursued his way until, being" Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "pursued" and "parted" (paragraph 7) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to faith and doubt: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 123 shapes its tone: "There was a scream, drowned immediately in a louder murmur of voices, fading into far-off laughter, as the dark cloud swept away, leaving the clear and silent sky above Goodman Brown." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "immediately" and "laughter" (paragraph 123) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to faith and doubt: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 134 to the story's treatment of faith and doubt: "In the interval of silence he stole forward until the light glared full upon his eyes." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 134) develops faith and doubt: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Its words "interval" and "forward" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "As the red light arose and fell, a numerous congregation alternately shone forth, then disappeared in shadow, and again…" (paragraph 134), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating faith and doubt as central.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Brown live after that night?

    A. As an exile

    B. As a minister

    C. Stern, sad and distrustful until death

    D. Happily with Faith

    Key: C (Stern, sad and distrustful until death)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 149: "Evil is the nature of _____"

    Key: mankind

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "My Faith is gone" (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 124) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The pun. The evidence is "My Faith is gone" (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 124). This develops loss of faith and innocence: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become" (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164).

    Sample answer: Whether the meeting was real or a dream, he becomes "a stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man," turning from Faith herself; the vision teaches him that "Evil is the nature of mankind," and he can never unlearn it. The evidence is "A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become" (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164) — His fate. This develops loss of faith and innocence: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone.

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 133 to the story's treatment of faith and doubt: "On he flew among the black pines, brandishing his staff with frenzied gestures, now giving vent to an inspiration of horrid blasphemy, and now shouting forth such laughter as set all the echoes of the forest laughing like demons around him." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 133) develops faith and doubt: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Its words "inspiration" and "brandishing" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "He paused, in a lull of the tempest that had driven him onward, and heard the swell of what seemed a hymn, rolling…" (paragraph 133), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating faith and doubt as central.

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "On came the hoof tramps and the voices of the riders, two grave old voices, _____ soberly as they drew near." Word bank: nettled, conversing, intercepted, auditor

    Key: conversing

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Brown see in the forest?

    A. Only strangers

    B. Indians only

    C. Pious townspeople and his minister

    D. No one

    Key: C (Pious townspeople and his minister)

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 21 shapes its tone: “South was striking as I came through Boston, and that is full” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “striking” and “through” (paragraph 21) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to faith and doubt: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 118 shapes its tone: “While he still gazed upward into the deep arch of the firmament and had lifted his hands to pr ay, a cloud, though no wind was stirring, hurried across the zenith and hid the brightening stars.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “brightening” and “firmament” (paragraph 118) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to faith and doubt: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “My Faith is gone” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 124) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The pun. The evidence is “My Faith is gone” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 124). This develops loss of faith and innocence: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Whether the meeting was real or a dream, he becomes "a stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man," turning from Faith herself; the vision teaches him that "Evil is the nature of mankind," and he can never unlearn it.
27. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 1: “Young Goodman Brown came forth at sunset into the street at Salem village; but put his head back, after crossing the _____, to exchange a parting kiss with his young wife.” Word bank: tremble, people, acquainted, threshold
    Key: threshold
28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: His fate. The evidence is “A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164). This develops loss of faith and innocence: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The words “distrustful” and “meditative” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.
29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 44 to the story's treatment of faith and doubt: “They were my good friends, both; and many a pleasant walk have we had along this path, and returned merrily after midnight.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 44) develops faith and doubt: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Its words “pleasant” and “midnight” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “But, were I to go on with thee, how should I meet the eye of that good old man, our minister, at Salem village?” (paragraph 56), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating faith and doubt as central.
30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 82 to the story's treatment of faith and doubt: “Accordingly the young man turned aside, but took care to watch his companion, who advanced softly along the road until he had come within a staff's length of the old dame.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 82) develops faith and doubt: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love

anyone. Its words “companion” and “advanced” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The traveller put forth his staff and touched her withered neck with what seemed the serpent's tail.” (paragraph 82), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating faith and doubt as central.

31. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] In the line “considerably nettled, ‘there is my wife, Faith.”, what does “nettled” most nearly mean?

    A. irritated; annoyed

    B. in a self-collected or self-possessed manner

    C. blocked; cut off (the light)

    D. someone who listens attentively

    Key: A (irritated; annoyed)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Young Goodman Brown”? Names are meanings: Goodman Brown (an everyman) and Faith; the journey into the forest is a journey into doubt.

    A. Allegory

    B. Imagery

    C. Hyperbole

    D. Structure

    Key: A (Allegory)

33. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] In the line “They continued to walk onward, while the elder traveller exhorted his companion to make good speed and persevere in the path, discoursing so aptly that his arguments seemed rather to spring up in the bosom of his…”, what does “auditor” most nearly mean?

    A. blocked; cut off (the light)

    B. irritated; annoyed

    C. in a self-collected or self-possessed manner

    D. someone who listens attentively

    Key: D (someone who listens attentively)

34. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] In the line “composedly. ‘Sit here and rest yourself a while; and when you”, what does “composedly” most nearly mean?

    A. in a self-collected or self-possessed manner

    B. irritated; annoyed

    C. someone who listens attentively

    D. blocked; cut off (the light)

    Key: A (in a self-collected or self-possessed manner)

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Synthesis: trace how loss of faith and innocence develops from the opening of “Young Goodman Brown” to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.
    Sample answer: Near the start, “My Faith is gone” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 124) — The pun. Later, “A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164) — His fate. Once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone.

36. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] In the line “Though their figures brushed the small boughs by the wayside, it could not be seen that they intercepted, even for a moment, the faint gleam from the strip of bright sky athwart which they must have passed.”, what does “intercepted” most nearly mean?

    A. blocked; cut off (the light)

    B. someone who listens attentively

    C. in a self-collected or self-possessed manner

    D. irritated; annoyed

    Key: A (blocked; cut off (the light))

37. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? “Evil is the nature of mankind” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 149) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The devil's sermon. The evidence is “Evil is the nature of mankind” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 149). This develops loss of faith and innocence: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone.

38. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which choice best states a central concern of “Young Goodman Brown”?

    A. The loss of faith in human goodness

    B. The art of the deadpan tall tale

    C. Self-destruction and the urge to do wrong

    D. Science that poisons love

    Key: A (The loss of faith in human goodness)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Evil is the nature of mankind” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 149) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The devil's sermon. The evidence is “Evil is the nature of mankind” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 149). This develops loss of faith and innocence: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The words “mankind” and “nature” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Whether the meeting was real or a dream, he becomes "a stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man," turning from Faith herself; the vision teaches him that "Evil is the nature of mankind," and he can never unlearn it.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	9, 10, 17, 2, 7, 1, 6, 8, 18, 13, 19, 12, 14, 15, 20, 21	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	4, 18, 7, 22, 6, 23, 17, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 24, 25, 21, 26	recall 9, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	18, 1, 5, 17, 27, 3, 9, 4, 12, 13, 14, 28, 25, 24, 29, 26	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	5, 1, 4, 2, 18, 22, 12, 19, 13, 24, 25, 15, 14, 16, 29, 30	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	1, 2, 27, 23, 8, 6, 15, 24, 25, 20, 14, 26, 29, 30, 16, 21	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Freshman	1, 31, 4, 11, 10, 24, 32, 15, 28, 25, 14, 16, 21, 29, 26, 30	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	1, 5, 11, 10, 8, 12, 24, 14, 25, 32, 15, 26, 30, 21, 16, 29	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5

College Junior	33, 6, 11, 1, 2, 34, 12, 14, 25, 24, 15, 16, 35, 21, 29, 30	recall 6, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Senior	3, 11, 1, 36, 31, 37, 38, 24, 14, 15, 25, 30, 29, 21, 26, 16	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	2, 11, 1, 23, 8, 9, 24, 14, 15, 16, 29, 21, 30, 35, 26, 39	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 3, synthesis 7

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Young Goodman Brown," how does Hawthorne show the loss of faith in human goodness? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the allusion you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1): In Young Goodman Brown, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the loss of faith in human goodness? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the allusion in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Young Goodman Brown develops the idea of the loss of faith in human goodness. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of Young Goodman Brown (where it begins, turns and ends) and its allusion shape the reader's understanding of the loss of faith in human goodness. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what Young Goodman Brown suggests about the loss of faith in human goodness. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's allusion and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses allusion in Young Goodman Brown to complicate the reader's understanding of the loss of faith in human goodness. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Young Goodman Brown within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of the loss of faith in human goodness responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Young Goodman Brown alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of the loss of faith in human goodness follows or bends those conventions, using the allusion as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Young Goodman Brown and its treatment of the loss of faith in human goodness. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's allusion and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Young Goodman Brown as evidence for a larger claim about the loss of faith in human goodness in Young Goodman Brown. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Young Goodman Brown as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of the loss of faith in human goodness. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Young Goodman Brown.

SAT-style questions

1. *They continued to walk onward, while the elder traveller exhorted his companion to make good speed and persevere in the path, discoursing so aptly that his arguments seemed rather to spring up in the bosom of his auditor than to be suggested by himself.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “auditor” most nearly mean?

   A. carry on a conversation

   B. someone who listens attentively

   C. to a great extent or degree

   D. feeling unsure

2. *They continued to walk onward, while the elder traveller exhorted his companion to make good speed and persevere in the path, discoursing so aptly that his arguments seemed rather to spring up in the bosom of his auditor than to be suggested by himself. As they went, he plucked a branch of maple to serve for a walking stick, and began to strip it of the twigs and little boughs, which were wet with evening dew. The moment his fingers touched them they became strangely withered and dried up as with a week's sunshine. Thus the pair proceeded, at a good free pace, until suddenly, in a gloomy hollow of the road, Goodman Brown sat himself down on the stump of a tree and refused to go any farther.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Young Goodman Brown”?

   A. A reversal that punishes a change of heart

   B. The foolishness of wishing to be young again

   C. Guilt that the mind cannot hide

   D. The loss of faith in human goodness

SAT key: 1. B (someone who listens attentively); 2. D (The loss of faith in human goodness)

Unit test

Young Goodman Brown: end test · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 26? “It was now deep dusk in the forest, and deepest in that part of it where these two were _____.”

   A. disappeared

   B. through

   C. journeying

   D. people

   Key: C (journeying)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 86: “But—would your worship believe it?—my broomstick hath strangely _____, stolen, as I suspect, by that unhanged witch, Goody Cory, and that, too, when I was all anointed with the juice of smallage, and cinquefoil, and wolf's bane’” Word bank: excellent, acquainted, journey, disappeared

   Key: disappeared

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 48: “We are a _____ of prayer, and good works to boot, and” Word bank: sometimes, people, threshold, indistinct

   Key: people

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 11: “Methought as she spoke there was _____ in her face, as if a dream had warned her what work is to be done tonight.” Word bank: tremble, acquainted, turned, trouble

   Key: trouble

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 2? “A lone woman is troubled with such dreams and such thoughts that she's afeard of herself _____.”

   A. trouble

   B. disappeared

   C. sometimes

   D. threshold

   Key: C (sometimes)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 3: “My _____, as thou callest it, forth and back again, must needs be done 'twixt now and sunrise.” Word bank: trouble, turned, journey, threshold

   Key: journey

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 82? “She, meanwhile, was making the best of her way, with singular speed for so aged a woman, and mumbling some _____ words—a prayer, doubtless—as she went.”

   A. turned

   B. trouble

   C. formerly

   D. indistinct

   Key: D (indistinct)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 56? “Oh, his voice would make me _____ both Sabbath day and lecture day.’”

   A. tremble

   B. journey

   C. turned

   D. through

   Key: A (tremble)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 12? “With this _____ resolve for the future, Goodman Brown felt himself justified in making more haste on his present evil purpose.”

   A. indistinct

   B. people

   C. tremble

   D. excellent

   Key: D (excellent)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 26: “But the only thing about him that could be fixed upon as _____ was his staff, which bore the likeness of a great black snake, so curiously wrought that it might almost be seen to twist and wriggle itself like a living serpent.” Word bank: through, indistinct, journey, remarkable

    Key: remarkable

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 133 reveal about the character or situation? “He paused, in a lull of the tempest that had driven him onward, and heard the swell of what seemed a hymn, rolling solemnly from a distance with the weight of many voices.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 133) shows the situation turning on hypocrisy: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The words “distance” and “solemnly” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in the story?

    A. “So they parted; and the young man pursued his way until, being”

B. “What, my sweet, pretty wife, dost thou doubt me already, and we but three months married?’”

C. “Then God bless you!’ said Faith, with the pink ribbons; ‘and may you find all well when you come back.”

D. “My journey, as thou callest it, forth and back again, must needs be done 'twixt now and sunrise.”

Key: D (“My journey, as thou callest it, forth and back again, must needs be done 'twixt now and sunrise.”)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 118 reveal about the character or situation? “The next moment, so indistinct were the sounds, he doubted whether he had heard aught but the murmur of the old forest, whispering without a wind.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 118) shows the situation turning on the nature of evil: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The words “indistinct” and “whispering” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 56 reveal about the character or situation? “But, were I to go on with thee, how should I meet the eye of that good old man, our minister, at Salem village?” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 56) shows the situation turning on hypocrisy: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The words “minister” and “village” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 127 shapes its tone: “But he was himself the chief horror of the scene, and shrank not from its other horrors.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “himself” and “horrors” (paragraph 127) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to the nature of evil: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 109 shapes its tone: “The young man sat a few moments by the roadside, applauding himself greatly, and thinking with how clear a conscience he should meet the minister in his morning walk, nor shrink from the eye of good old Deacon Gookin.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “conscience” and “applauding” (paragraph 109) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to hypocrisy: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

17. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 136 to the story's treatment of the nature of evil: “Either the sudden gleams of light flashing over the obscure field bedazzled Goodman Brown, or he recognized a score of the church members of Salem village famous for their especial sanctity.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 136) develops the nature of evil: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Its words “recognized” and “bedazzled” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “And Faith, as the wife was aptly named, thrust her own pretty head into the street, letting the wind play with the pink…” (paragraph 1), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the nature of evil as central.

18. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 12 reveal about the character or situation? “He had taken a dreary road, darkened by all the gloomiest trees of the forest, which barely stood aside to let the narrow path creep through, and closed immediately behind.” Answer in two or

three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 12) shows the situation turning on the nature of evil: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The words “immediately” and “gloomiest” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 134 shapes its tone: “As the red light arose and fell, a numerous congregation alternately shone forth, then disappeared in shadow, and again grew, as it were, out of the darkness, peopling the heart of the solitary woods at once.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “congregation” and “alternately” (paragraph 134) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to hypocrisy: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 2 shapes its tone: “Pray tarry with me this night, dear husband, of all nights in the year.’” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “husband” and “nights” (paragraph 2) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to hypocrisy: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 133 shapes its tone: “The verse died heavily away, and was lengthened by a chorus, not of human voices, but of all the sounds of the benighted wilderness pealing in awful harmony together.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “lengthened” and “wilderness” (paragraph 133) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to the nature of evil: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 11 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy: “Well, she's a blessed angel on earth; and after this one night I'll cling to her skirts and follow her to heaven.’” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 11) develops hypocrisy: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Its words “blessed” and “heaven” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “He had taken a dreary road, darkened by all the gloomiest trees of the forest, which barely stood aside to let the…” (paragraph 12), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy as central.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 70 shapes its tone: “As he spoke he pointed his staff at a female figure on the path,” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “pointed” and “female” (paragraph 70) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to the nature of evil: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 118 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy: “Aloft in the air, as if from the depths of the cloud, came a confused and doubtful sound of voices.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 118) develops hypocrisy: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Its words “doubtful” and “confused” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The next moment, so indistinct were the sounds, he doubted whether he had heard aught but the murmur of the old forest,…”

(paragraph 118), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy as central.

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 93 to the story's treatment of the nature of evil: “But now your good worship will lend me your arm, and we shall be” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 93) develops the nature of evil: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Its words “worship” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “He had cast up his eyes in astonishment, and, looking down again, beheld neither Goody Cloyse nor the serpentine staff,…” (paragraph 97), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the nature of evil as central.

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 82 shapes its tone: “The traveller put forth his staff and touched her withered neck with what seemed the serpent's tail.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “serpent's” and “traveller” (paragraph 82) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to hypocrisy: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 26 shapes its tone: “This, of course, must have been an ocular deception, assisted by the uncertain light.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “deception” and “uncertain” (paragraph 26) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to the nature of evil: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 26 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy: “As nearly as could be discerned, the second traveller was about fifty years old, apparently in the same rank of life as Goodman Brown, and bearing a considerable resemblance to him, though perhaps more in expression than features.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 26) develops hypocrisy: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Its words “considerable” and “resemblance” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “This, of course, must have been an ocular deception, assisted by the uncertain light.” (paragraph 26), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy as central.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 3 to the story's treatment of the nature of evil: “What, my sweet, pretty wife, dost thou doubt me already, and we but three months married?'” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 3) develops the nature of evil: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Its words “already” and “married” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “So they parted; and the young man pursued his way until, being” (paragraph 7), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the nature of evil as central.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 127 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy: “And, maddened with despair, so that he laughed loud and long, did Goodman Brown grasp his staff and set forth again, at such a rate that he seemed to fly along the forest path rather than to walk or run.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 127) develops hypocrisy: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Its words “maddened” and “laughed” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “But he was

himself the chief horror of the scene, and shrank not from its other horrors." (paragraph 127), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy as central.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 111 to the story's treatment of the nature of evil: "They tell me that some of our community are to be here from Falmouth and beyond, and others from Connecticut and Rhode Island, besides several of the Indian powwows, who, after their fashion, know almost as much deviltry as the best of us." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 111) develops the nature of evil: once Brown believes all are sinners, he cannot love anyone. Its words "community" and "deviltry" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "While he still gazed upward into the deep arch of the firmament and had lifted his hands to pr ay, a cloud, though no…" (paragraph 118), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the nature of evil as central.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17	recall 10, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	9, 5, 10, 3, 6, 8, 7, 4, 1, 2, 11, 18, 12, 14, 19, 20, 21, 22	recall 10, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	3, 8, 1, 7, 5, 10, 6, 13, 12, 18, 12, 14, 11, 23, 16, 21, 24, 25	recall 7, inference 6, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	1, 4, 5, 9, 6, 10, 12, 11, 13, 14, 12, 18, 26, 20, 27, 15, 28, 29	recall 6, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	4, 8, 1, 6, 7, 12, 11, 13, 18, 12, 14, 26, 23, 16, 15, 29, 25, 28	recall 5, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	9, 6, 3, 12, 18, 14, 11, 21, 15, 23, 16, 19, 27, 30, 22, 25, 17, 31	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Freshman	1, 3, 6, 18, 14, 12, 13, 27, 16, 20, 19, 15, 23, 31, 28, 24, 29, 25	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	3, 10, 5, 12, 14, 13, 19, 20, 23, 16, 21, 15, 22, 28, 25, 29, 17, 31	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 6, synthesis 6
College Junior	1, 7, 6, 12, 14, 16, 20, 27, 21, 26, 19, 30, 28, 29, 24, 17, 22, 25	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 7
College Senior	7, 6, 12, 11, 26, 21, 15, 27, 19, 23, 28, 24, 29, 17, 25, 31, 22, 30	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 8
Graduate / PhD	4, 9, 21, 27, 20, 23, 16, 19, 26, 15, 24, 22, 30, 29, 31, 25, 17, 28	recall 2, inference 0, analysis 8, synthesis 8

Final paper

Young Goodman Brown: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops faith and doubt across Young Goodman Brown. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in Young Goodman Brown and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to hypocrisy.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in Young Goodman Brown. Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether Young Goodman Brown finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of the nature of evil. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.	Specific, arguable and precise; it organizes every section.	Clear and arguable, but broad in places.	States a topic or a summary more than an argument.	Missing, or restates the prompt.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.	Accurate, well-chosen quotations from across the work, all cited; meets the requirement.	Accurate and cited, but clustered in one part of the work.	Too few quotations, or some inaccurate or uncited.	Little or no quoted evidence.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.	Explains how specific words, structure and devices create meaning; weighs a competing reading.	Explains the evidence, with some close reading.	Mostly summary; the link to the claim is asserted, not shown.	Summary only.

Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.	Each paragraph advances the argument; transitions show logic.	Logical order with minor jumps.	Order is loose; paragraphs repeat or drift.	No discernible structure.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.	Formal, precise, present tense; MLA format; virtually error-free.	Formal with a few errors that do not obscure meaning.	Informal or error-prone in ways that distract.	Errors obscure meaning.

Exemplar paragraph: Brown's real loss is not the evil he sees but his inability to trust anyone afterward. The text makes this visible when it says “A stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man did he become” (Young Goodman Brown, paragraph 164). Whether the meeting was real or a dream, he becomes "a stern, a sad, a darkly meditative, a distrustful, if not a desperate man," turning from Faith herself; the vision teaches him that "Evil is the nature of mankind," and he can never unlearn it. A full paper would carry this reading through the beginning, middle and end, and answer the strongest competing reading.

Essay assignments

Essay: Faith and doubt

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Young Goodman Brown teaches about faith and doubt. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops faith and doubt in Young Goodman Brown. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops faith and doubt across Young Goodman Brown. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Young Goodman Brown (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of faith and doubt. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of faith and doubt in Young Goodman Brown. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in Young Goodman Brown (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of faith and doubt, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Young Goodman Brown's treatment of faith and doubt in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on faith and doubt in Young Goodman Brown that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on faith and doubt in Young Goodman Brown. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about faith and doubt in Young Goodman Brown, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on faith and doubt in Young Goodman Brown, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Hypocrisy

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Young Goodman Brown teaches about hypocrisy. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops hypocrisy in Young Goodman Brown. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops hypocrisy across Young Goodman Brown. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Young Goodman Brown (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of hypocrisy. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of hypocrisy in Young Goodman Brown. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in Young Goodman Brown (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of hypocrisy, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Young Goodman Brown's treatment of hypocrisy in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on hypocrisy in Young Goodman Brown that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on hypocrisy in Young Goodman Brown. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about hypocrisy in Young Goodman Brown, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on hypocrisy in Young Goodman Brown, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: The nature of evil

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Young Goodman Brown teaches about the nature of evil. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops the nature of evil in Young Goodman Brown. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops the nature of evil across Young Goodman Brown. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Young Goodman Brown (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the nature of evil. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the nature of evil in Young Goodman Brown. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in Young Goodman Brown (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the nature of evil, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Young Goodman Brown's treatment of the nature of evil in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the nature of evil in Young Goodman Brown that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the nature of evil in Young Goodman Brown. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

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Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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